



BOISE GEMS PERFORMING ARTS

2026 Gems Drum & Bugle Corps Member Contract

Congratulations!

You have been selected as a member of the 2026 Boise Gems Drum and Bugle Corps! You are now on an incredible journey that has already begun with hours of hard work and preparation. You should be commended for your commitment to excellence.

This contract is a binding agreement between you and Boise Gems Performing Arts, Inc.(Gems Drum and Bugle Corps, Inc). In this agreement, there are detailed expectations for membership. Please read carefully and understand your entire commitment as a member of this organization.

Rules and Expectations

Our rules and expectations are detailed in the Member Handbook, and signing this contract indicates you (or parent if the member is under 18) have read and agree to abide by them.

Paperwork and Documents

Your place in the corps is not secure until this contract is signed and returned with the \$200 contract deposit. If this contract is not signed and returned with the \$200 contract deposit within one month from when the contract is offered, this contract is void, and a re-audition will be required to be offered a contract again for the season.

Proof of Age

Drum Corps International requires that we verify the age of our members for eligibility. A drivers license, student id, birth certificate or other official document that displays the member's birthdate. The document will only need to be presented at camp check-in following a contract offer and return. We will not collect or copy this document.

Schedule/Attendance Agreement

Attendance is of paramount importance for any group of people to accomplish goals and achieve a high level of excellence. Academic and school music-related events constitute acceptable conflicts. Valid excuse for absences will be allowed if the director and staff are notified prior to becoming a member of the organization. All personal time (such as vacations) should be scheduled to avoid conflicts with rehearsals and performances.

2026 Gems Drum & Bugle Corps

Member Contract

Schedule/Attendance Agreement (continued)

The Attendance Agreement, which is supplemental to this contract, specifies your commitment of time and attendance to the rehearsals, camps, performances, and tour. This document is found within your contract and is also available online through your member portal. This agreement/commitment is REQUIRED to be considered officially contracted, otherwise your spot may not be secured. Maintaining your commitment to rehearsal attendance is critical to your success, the success of your section, and of the entire organization. Understand that failure to fulfill this commitment will be grounds for removal from the program or a reduction in membership status without refund.

Medical Insurance Card

If the member has medical insurance, you will be asked to send a copy for your member account and documents.

Health Liability/Emergency Medical Form

We use this form in case of an emergency. You will provide emergency medical and physician contacts, medical insurance information, any medical conditions and prescriptions, etc.

Conduct and Discipline

Members are expected to always conduct themselves in a respectful and responsible manner, whether in rehearsal, at a performance, or during personal time. Conduct unbecoming and not in accordance with the Code of Conduct of BGPA will not be tolerated and will result in disciplinary action or release from the organization. Insubordination to staff, volunteers, or other members will not be tolerated, and will be grounds for immediate disciplinary action or termination of membership without refund. See Member Handbook.

Band Participation

Any member of a high school music program must remain a member in good standing in that program while participating in any BGPA program. Any high school member dropping out of their band program without written release from their director or principal will be dropped from the organization without refund.

Equipment

BGPA will provide some equipment of its own and equipment that has been provided to us by sponsors for the benefit of our student members. The full cost of replacing/repairing lost or damaged instruments/equipment is the responsibility of the member to whom they were issued. Ultimate care and protection of all equipment and instruments used by you is expected.

2026 Gems Drum & Bugle Corps

Member Contract

Housing Sites

Members must follow the rules established by our hosts at our rehearsal/housing facilities. All facilities must be left in the same or better condition than which they were found. You will be required to help with various cleaning duties as designated by the staff and/or student leaders. Ultimate care and respect for guests and staff of hotel properties that the corps may be staying at will be expected.

Personal Belongings

Gems DBC will not accept responsibility for lost, stolen, or damaged personal belongings of any member, staff, or volunteer.

Drug/Smoking/Alcohol

There is NO smoking or use of any tobacco products including e-cigarettes by members. Drinking alcohol and use of illegal or non-prescribed drugs are not permitted. Prescription medicine should be noted on your medical release form and the Directors should be notified of any special conditions requiring medication. Possession and/or use of prohibited substances will be grounds for immediate release from the corps without refund. See Member Handbook.

Policy on Protection from Harassment and Discrimination

An understanding and adherence to this policy is an important responsibility of membership. Please take time to examine this policy, which can be found in your Member Handbook or via your online member portal.

Financial Commitment

Membership Dues

The 2026 Membership Dues will be \$1200, and includes all staff instruction and guest clinician expenses, housing, training, and touring transportation, most meals, uniforms and costumes and other operational expenses. A \$200 deposit is due within one month of receiving this contract offer, or this contract is void.

The member is responsible for their own transportation to join the corps for training and driving or flying home after the season concludes.

Membership Dues will be paid through in person payments, or online via your member portal. After signing your contract, your account will be prepared for your member dues. You will have the option to mail or bring your payments to the office or camp, or pay online. You will be able to view your account and make additional payments at any time by requesting to do so via our email; theboisegems@gmail.com.

2026 Gems Drum & Bugle Corps

Member Contract

Additional Member Expenses

Members are responsible for purchasing any personal items that may be required such as rehearsal gloves, instrument repairs, a binder and clear plastic page holders for music and other papers, and any additional attire required for the 2026 uniform (i.e., under shirts, socks, tights, make-up, guard performance gloves and shoes, etc.).

Timely Payments and Refunds

Dues and other fees must be paid on time. A two-week grace period (with valid reason) will be allowed for delayed payment of dues and fees.

MEMBERS WILL NOT BE ALLOWED TO PERFORM WITH THE REST OF THE CORPS IF THEIR DUES ARE NOT PAID IN FULL.

A \$300 Late Fee will be assessed and added to the remaining total if a member does not pay their complete financial commitment IN FULL BY Saturday, May 23rd, 2026.

*DUES AND FEES ARE NON-REFUNDABLE for any reason, including early release for lack of attendance, injury, illness, or disciplinary or character issues not becoming of a member of the organization. Failure to pay, or abuse of the grace period, will be grounds for release from the organization without refund, and the unpaid balance will be billed until it is paid. In the event the season is canceled, a refund schedule will be followed depending on the date of the cancellation.

Member Sponsorship Donation Refunds

In the event of season cancellation, donations made to a member's account will be refunded directly to the donor less any non-refundable portion.

These contributions, including donations from businesses, cannot be considered tax-deductible donations as they are strictly directed to the member's financial obligation

I (and my parents if under 18) have read this contract and the Member Handbook, along with all policies mentioned in this contract.

I/we understand any violation of these rules and obligations could result in my suspension or dismissal.

I/we agree to meet all financial obligations as prescribed herein.

With complete understanding of these requirements, I am prepared to make my full commitment to the 2026 Gems Drum and Bugle Corps.

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Name (please print): _____

Signature of parent or legal guardian (if under 18 years of age):

Boise Gems Performing Arts Attendance Agreement

1. Purpose and Commitment

As a member of Boise Gems Performing Arts, I understand that my attendance and punctuality are fundamental to the success of the ensemble and to fulfilling our shared goals of musical excellence, teamwork, and positive culture. I commit to being present, on time, prepared, and engaged for all scheduled rehearsals, trainings, sectionals, performances, and tour days unless excused in advance.

2. Attendance and Rehearsal Expectations

I will clear my personal schedule so I am able to attend every scheduled rehearsal, camp, and performance as outlined in the official BGPA calendar.

Rehearsals, block times, sectionals, warm-ups, and transition calls are not optional — each member's presence impacts the whole ensemble.

If I foresee a conflict (school event, family emergency, etc.), I will contact the designated staff member (Caption Head/ Ensemble Coordinator) as soon as possible, ideally two weeks prior when foreseeable.

Your member contract states: 'In order to maintain the high level of performance excellence, we must have full attendance at rehearsals. Please clear your personal schedule so you can attend all practices and camps.'

School-related conflicts are given priority, but I must still notify staff in advance and abide by internal procedure for excused absence.

3. Tardiness

Arriving late to call-time, rehearsal, warm-up, or performance is disruptive and will be treated accordingly. Repeated tardiness may be treated with the same consequences as an unexcused absence.

4. Excused vs. Non-Excused Absences

Excused Absences include illness documented by a guardian or medical professional, family emergencies, unavoidable school conflicts approved in advance, or other reasons explicitly approved by staff.

Unexcused Absences include missing a scheduled activity without prior approval, failing to communicate the absence in the required timeframe, or leaving rehearsal without permission. An unexcused absence significantly compromises the ensemble's readiness and may result in immediate review.

5. Consequences of Absence/Tardiness

Two unexcused absences or multiple tardies may result in loss of part assignment, reassignment of role, probation, or dismissal from the corps for the season.

Missing a performance without an excused reason may jeopardize eligibility for future participation in any BGPA ensemble.

Staff will maintain an attendance ledger; members will be informed when their attendance status is in jeopardy.

Boise Gems Performing Arts Attendance Agreement

6. Performance, Spring Training, Travel & Tour Obligations

Attendance for all days of Spring Training is mandatory unless approved in advance.

For tour, attendance through the entire tour/travel schedule is required.

Performances, trailer loading, warm-ups, and facility clean up are part of one unified commitment; missing any component may count as an absence.

7. Communication Requirements

I will respond promptly when staff asks for attendance confirmations, check-ins, RSVP, or scheduling updates via the designated communication platform.

I will notify my Caption Head/Ensemble Coordinator if I must be absent or late, following the procedure established by staff.

Failure to communicate may result in the absence being marked as unexcused.

8. Professional Conduct and Team Mindset

My attendance and punctuality reflect respect for my peers, instructors, staff, and the corps culture we are building. I agree to approach every rehearsal, camp, tour day, and performance with humility, enthusiasm, preparedness, and a willingness to contribute.

9. Acknowledgement

By signing below, I acknowledge that I have read, understood, and agree to abide by the attendance expectations of BGPA I recognize that my membership is contingent on fulfilling this agreement, and that failure to comply may result in disciplinary measures, including possible removal from the corps.

Program (Gems DBC or BGI): _____ Season: _____

Member Name (First Last): _____

Instrument/Section: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Parent/Guardian (if under 18): _____ Date: _____

2026 Gems Drum & Bugle Corps

Financial Agreement Form

Purpose

Participation in the Gems Drum & Bugle Corps (Gems DBC) requires a financial commitment that supports instruction, facilities, transportation, equipment, and operational expenses necessary for a high-quality member experience. This agreement ensures a clear understanding between the member (and parent/guardian, if under 18) and Gems DBC regarding dues, deadlines, and expectations.

1. Member Financial Obligation

The total member tuition for the 2026 season is \$1,200.00. This amount covers instruction, music rights, uniforms, transportation, housing, facility rentals, and other administrative expenses. All members must meet the payment deadlines below or contact the administrative team in advance to discuss an approved plan.

2. Payment Schedule

Payment Due Date	Amount Due	Description
At the time of contract return (within 30 days of being offered a contract).	\$200	Initial non-refundable deposit securing membership.
January 15 th , 2026	\$200	Monthly Payment #1
February 15 th , 2026	\$200	Monthly Payment #2
March 15 th , 2026	\$200	Monthly Payment #3
April 15 th , 2026	\$200	Monthly Payment #4
May 15 th , 2026	\$200	Final payment — All dues must be paid in full by May 23, 2026.

Dues may be paid in full at any time or in larger advance installments via the member portal or in person at camp.

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3. Members Contracted After November/December 2025

Members offered a contract after December 31, 2025 are still responsible for the full \$1,200 tuition. These members must:

Catch up on any missed payments promptly. (Example: If contracted in January, the member should pay the January installment at the next camp, ideally together with or before the February payment.)

Stay current on all remaining due dates so the full balance is complete by May 23, 2026.

Coordinate with administration to finalize a short-term adjusted schedule if needed.

4. Payment Methods

Payments may be made by:

Online portal (preferred)

Check or money order payable to Boise Gems Performing Arts (Attn: Gems Drum and Bugle Corps, Inc)

Cash in person at a scheduled event or camp

Always include the member's full name and section on every payment when and where possible.

5. Late Payment Policy

A two-week grace period may be granted with valid reason if communicated in advance.

After that grace period, a \$500 late fee will be added to the remaining balance if dues are not paid in full by May 23, 2026.

Members with overdue balances may be:

Suspended from rehearsals or performances

Declared ineligible for Spring Training or Tour

Dismissed from the corps at the discretion of administration

Consistent with the Member Contract, dues and fees must be paid on time to remain in good standing.

Members experiencing legitimate financial hardship must contact the Executive Director, the Treasurer, and Administrative Director immediately to discuss arrangements or fundraising opportunities.

6. Refund Policy

The initial \$200 deposit and all subsequent dues are non-refundable.

Refunds will not be issued for withdrawal, dismissal, injury, or inability to participate.

If the season is canceled, a refund schedule will be determined by BGPA/Gems DBC administration.

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Financial Agreement Form

7. Fundraising Opportunities

Members may participate in approved Gems DBC Member fundraising activities to reduce individual dues. All proceeds are applied directly to the member's account and are non-transferable. Note: Some fundraisers are as an effort to raise money for the entire corps, not just the individual, so be sure to ask or take note of when and where that is discussed.

8. Communication Requirement

Members are responsible for remaining current on all payments and must notify administration immediately of any delay. Failure to communicate may result in additional fees or loss of membership standing.

9. Acknowledgment

By signing below, I acknowledge that I have read, understood, and agree to the financial obligations outlined in this form. I understand that all dues must be paid in full by May 23, 2026, and that failure to meet these requirements or communicate with administration may result in late fees, suspension, or removal from the corps.

Member Name: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Parent/Guardian (if under 18): _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Administrative Signature: _____ Date: _____

Boise Gems Performing Arts

Youth Protection Policy

Boise Gems Performing Arts has adopted several policies aimed at eliminating opportunities for abuse within the Organization's programs. The main purpose of this youth protection policy is to protect children from harm while in BGPA's programs and services, whether from adults or other participants.

In consideration of the following policy, employees, staff, contractors, or volunteers working with any program or service of BGPA's will be referred to as ("Adults" and/or "Personnel") and any student, member, or participant will be referred to as ("Participants"). When discussing any combined Adult/Personnel and/or Participant will be referred to as ("Individual" or "Person"). Sexual misconduct, including sexual harassment, non-consensual sexual acts and/or contact, sexual exploitation and stalking is strictly prohibited.

Many people have experienced "teasing" as a part of their life experiences. The question is, when does teasing cross the line and become harassment? This is important because, unlike teasing, harassment can have significant negative effects on the individuals who are subject to it – humiliating and degrading them or causing them to feel threatened.

Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment by definition is unwelcome sexual conduct that either creates a hostile environment or is presented as a demand in exchange for gaining something (in the workplace or institution). Such behavior is illegal. Sexual harassment encompasses a broad spectrum of behaviors that are generally defined to include the following:

Visual: Ogling or staring; or inappropriate posters, pictures, magazines, or fliers.

Verbal: Repeated requests for dates, questions about personal life, lewd comments/jokes, or whistling.

Written: Love letters, obscene letters, or lewd bumper stickers or cards.

Touching: Violating space, patting/grabbing, pinching, caressing, or kissing.

Power: Relationships; using position to request dates, sex, etc.

Threats: Quid pro quo demands (I'll give you preferential treatment if ...)

Force: Physical assault or rape.

Sexual Assault

Sexual Assault includes physical sexual acts perpetrated against a person's will or where a person is incapable of giving consent because of his or her temporary or permanent mental or physical incapacity, because they are below the minimum age of consent, or because they are incapacitated due to the use of drugs and/or alcohol.

Boise Gems Performing Arts

Youth Protection Policy

Sexual Exploitation

Sexual Exploitation includes taking sexual advantage of another person for the benefit of oneself or a third party without consent. This includes, but is not limited to, sexual voyeurism, indecent or lewd exposure, recording any person engaged in sexual, private, or intimate activity in a private space without that person's consent, distributing personal sexual information, images, or recordings or inducing incapacitation in another person with the intent to engage in sexual conduct.

Stalking

Stalking is engaging in a course of conduct directed at a specific person that would cause a reasonable person to (A) fear for their safety or the safety of others; or (B) suffer substantial emotional distress. Stalking includes conduct that occurs via electronic communications, including social media (i.e., cyberstalking).

BARRIERS TO ABUSE

BGPA takes great pride in the high quality of its employees, staff, contractors, and volunteers. Being personnel of BGPA is a privilege, not a right. The quality of the programs and the safety of the participants call for exemplary adult leaders. Thus, BGPA works to recruit the best possible leaders.

Applications for initial and continuing employment or contract work are strictly scrutinized, including all necessary and appropriate background checks before an applicant is allowed to work. While no current screening techniques exist that can identify every potential child molester, one can reduce the risk of accepting possible child molesters by learning as much as one can prior to offering placement (experience with children, reason for interest in BGPA, discipline techniques the applicant would employ, etc.).

BGPA has adopted the following policies in order to provide additional security for all participants. These policies are designed primarily for the protection of the participants; however, they also serve to protect the personnel from false accusation of abuse.

Two-Deep Interaction

Either two members of BGPA personnel, or one participant plus a screened volunteer, one of whom must be at least 21 years of age or older, are required to be present for every gathering (rehearsal, events, performance, or other), or outing (concerts, events, tours, or other).

No One-on-One Contact

One-on-one private meetings between personnel and participants is permitted in situations that require personal attention, such as private conferences, instruction, or the like. The meeting is to be conducted in view of other adults, and/or participants or be an open-door meeting. Should an exceptional situation require direct one-on-one contact (such as a single adult driving a sole participant to camp), such contact may be permitted only with the clear and direct approval of the participant's parent or legal guardian, or if over 18 written approval by the participant filed in BGPA's files.

Boise Gems Performing Arts

Youth Protection Policy

Additional Transportation

For trips using transportation organized by BGPA to and from BGPA functions, the adult must do the following: 1) designate a meeting place, date, and time; 2) establish a plan for making periodic checkpoint stops as a group along the route; and 3) plan daily destination points. For larger vehicles, supervision by two adults is optimal. For smaller vehicles, supervision by one adult is acceptable; however, the vehicle must carry a minimum of two or more participants. In non-emergency/non-medical situations, one-adult-to-one-participant travel is not acceptable unless the adult is the participant's parent or legal guardian.

Large Single-Room or Dormitory-Type Accommodations

Adults and participants of the same gender may occupy dormitory or large single-room accommodations, provided there is a minimum of two adults and four participants. Further, a minimum of one of the adults must be a BGPA adult who is familiar with BGPA child safety policies. Adults must establish separation barriers or privacy zones such as temporary blanket or sheet walls in order to keep their sleeping areas and dressing areas separated from the youth.

Sleeping Facilities

Male and female participant require separate male and female sleeping facilities. In most cases, the facilities will be large single-room or dormitory- type accommodations explained in section 2. In this case all male and female participant will be separated by a large dividing space. There will be a mandatory policy of ONE sleeping bag/blanket per ONE participant.

Supervision of Overnight Stays

Coed overnight activities require male and female adult leaders, both of whom must be 21 years of age or older, and one must be a BGPA adult who is familiar with BGPA child safety policies. No individual youth will share sleeping facilities with one adult unless the adult is the participant's parent or legal guardian.

Restroom and Shower Facilities

If separate shower and restroom facilities are not available, separate times for male and female use will be scheduled and posted. Further, participants should be encouraged to visit such facilities in groups of two or more. Finally, when possible, the doors on restroom stalls should provide privacy latches or display signs that say Occupied or Unoccupied. Everyone need to respect the privacy in all situations where appropriate such as when participants are changing clothes or taking showers understanding that at times the facilities do not have separate adult and participant locker rooms.

BGPA does not discriminate, and accommodations will be handled to the best of our ability based on a number of factors, including but not limited to type of request, facilities and scheduling. Please consult with the director or manager onsite.

Boise Gems Performing Arts

Youth Protection Policy

Safety Rule of Four

No fewer than four individuals, two adults and two participants, may participate in an event organized by BGPA. Only in the event of emergency may a group of four separate into two independent groups. In such instances the two independent groups must each consist of one adult and one participant.

Social Gatherings

Any staff participating in a social gathering that includes current participants must recognize that such a function will be considered an official gathering of BGPA, requiring notification to and permission from management. All BGPA rules and policies will therefore be in effect at such a gathering, and staff behavior must conform to all work standards and expectations.

Proper Preparation to Minimize Risk

All activities involve inherent risk. All activities should be reviewed. No activity that involves increased risk should be undertaken without proper preparation, equipment, clothing, supervision, and safety measures.

No Secret Organizations/Social Groups

BGPA does not recognize any secret organizations or social groups as part of the organization. All activities of BGPA are open to observations by parents, personnel, and volunteers.

Appropriate Attire

Proper clothing for activities is required. No swimsuits, no jeans, no open toed shoes, no boots, and clothing must cover all private body parts, etc. Shirts are not allowed to be removed.

Constructive Discipline

Discipline used in BGPA should be constructive and reflect high values. Corporal punishment is never permitted. Please see BGPA "Handbook for Members", for a further explanation of policy.

Hazing Prohibited

Any and all kinds of hazing and/or initiations are prohibited and may not be included as part of any BGPA procedure.

Training and Supervision of New Personnel

Senior adults must monitor and guide the leadership/instruction techniques used by junior adults to ensure that all policies are followed.

Boise Gems Performing Arts Youth Protection Policy

HOW CAN PARENTS HELP PROTECT THEIR CHILDREN?

Parents participate in the protection of their children in a variety of ways. The most important is to maintain open lines of communication so that children are encouraged to bring any troubles to their parents for advice and counsel. In addition, parents need to be encouraged to participate in BGPA activities and events. All parents have access to important information concerning BGPA's various programs and should be reviewed before participation. This information will help parents detect any deviations from BGPA's approved programs and activities. If any deviations are noted, parents should be encouraged to call these to the direct attention of the BGPA president, director, manager, and/or Board of Directors for assistance.

While we hope that all those who come in contact with BGPA personnel feel unhindered and unthreatened in raising concerns, complaints, and issues, we recognize that it is essential to also provide for confidential and anonymous submission of such concerns, complaints, and issues, to ensure BGPA has the full opportunity to investigate and address any potential violations of policy, law, or ordinance in the conduct of our activities. BGPA "Whistle Blower" policy can be accessed on our web page.

Anyone may report any concerns or issues via a form on our web page form and it will be sent to the ethics committee composed of BGPA's Director and BOD President. You can also email any concerns or issues directly to theboisegems@gmail.com.

WHY DO MOST CHILD VICTIMS OF SEXUAL ABUSE KEEP THE ABUSE SECRET?

A victim of child abuse is under a great deal of pressure to keep the abuse secret. In many cases of child molestation, the molester has threatened to harm the child or a member of the child's family. The molester might have told the child that he would not be believed even if the child did tell. Another common situation is that the molester will tell the child that if the child talks about the abuse, he/she will get into trouble. The clear message is given to the child that if other persons find out, something bad will happen to the child.

The pressure to maintain silence can often be successfully overcome by establishing open communication between children and adults, students, and faculty, through proper discussion sessions.

Boise Gems Performing Arts Youth Protection Policy

WHAT SHOULD AN ADULT DO IF A PARTICIPANT OR CHILD TELLS THEM THAT THERE HAS BEEN SEXUAL ABUSE?

How an adult responds to a child when he/she tries to disclose abuse can influence the outcome of the child's victimization. By maintaining an apparent calm, the adult can help reassure the child that everything is going to be okay. By not criticizing the child, one counteracts any statements the molester may have made about getting the child into trouble. The adult should reassure the child that he/she is concerned and that the adult will arrange help.

Allegations by a BGPA participant concerning abuse in any BGPA program or activity must be reported to the president, director, manager, or a member of the Board of Directors. The participant is not required to tell the director, but if they tell their parent or a lower-level staff member, etc. they are required to notify the president to make the next call. Since this might be a mandatory reporting requirement, a participant should be told that the information about the abuse will be forwarded to the proper authorities and not anyone else.

It is important that all adults of BGPA understand that any report of abuse must only be given to either the president, director, manager, or a member of the Board of Directors. BGPA will report the abuse to authorities if necessary. If a report is relayed to anyone else, and the allegations cannot be substantiated, the reporting adult could be sued for defamation of character.

WHAT ARE YOUR REPORTING RESPONSIBILITIES?

In general, Idaho state law (Idaho. Title 16, Sec.16-1605) states that any adult administrator, employee, teacher, teacher's aide, volunteer, or others; for either a public or a private organization; whose duties include either direct contact with, or supervision over children; has a mandatory duty to report child abuse. People are often concerned about being sued for reporting child abuse. Please note that a person is not required to know for certain that a child has been abused. All that the law requires is that a person have 1) reasonable suspicion, and 2) that the report is being made in "good faith". When these requirements are met, all states provide immunity from liability for child abuse reporters.

Boise Gems Performing Arts

Youth Protection Policy

PARTICIPANT BEHAVIOR GUIDELINES

Mission Statement: BGPA permanently enriches the lives of young people through a commitment to youth development and performance excellence, while providing enjoyment for our local community and audiences worldwide.

Music and the performing arts connect youth with their culture through a common language; crossing generational, social, and racial barriers. The activities that a young person pursues influences the type of person he or she becomes. The experience that comes with participation in a performing arts organization builds discipline, character, pride, and self-confidence at a crucial age and forms the springboard to even greater achievements in adulthood.

BGPA has the expectation that all participants within programs and services relate to each other in a way that supports this mission.

One of the developmental tasks of childhood is to learn appropriate behavior. Children are not born with an innate sense of propriety and thus need guidance and direction. The examples set by BGPA is a powerful tool for shaping behavior and a tool that is stressed by BGPA.

Misbehavior by a single participant may disrupt the education process. Further, misbehavior during activities may actually constitute a threat to the safety of the individual who misbehaves as well as to the safety of the other participants. Therefore, as misbehavior places an unacceptable burden on all adults and participants of BGPA, it cannot be ignored.

Please see the "Code of Conduct" sections in the handbook or agreement, as it pertains to you, for a more complete discussion of this subject.

PARTICIPANT RESPONSIBILITIES

Participants in BGPA are expected to conduct themselves in accordance with the normal principals of socially responsible behavior and BGPA's Code of Conduct. Physical violence, sexual harassment, non-consensual sexual acts and/or contact, sexual exploitation, stalking, hazing, bullying, theft, verbal abuse, drugs, and alcohol have no place in BGPA. Anyone found guilty of engaging in unacceptable behavior may be expelled from the organization.

Further, personnel, employees, volunteers, and staff are required to advise BGPA students that should they be confronted by threats of violence or other forms of bullying from anyone they should seek help from any adult.

ADULT RESPONSIBILITIES

All adults are responsible for monitoring the behavior of participants under their responsibility, and/or supervision and are required to intercede when necessary. Parents of students who misbehave should be informed by the Director and asked for assistance in dealing with their child's behavioral problems.

The president, director, manager, and/or the Board of Directors will review repetitive and/or serious incidents of misbehavior.

Boise Gems Performing Arts

Youth Protection Policy

COMMUNICATION PROTOCOLS

Communications between adults and participants should always be of a professional, not-personal nature. If a person's thoughts are not specifically focused on BGPA's activities and requirements, or they cannot or shouldn't be said in front of another adult or participant's parent, it should definitely not be said to a participant. There is no tolerance for adults crossing the line into a participant's personal mental or physical space. There is no tolerance for an adult using suggestive language, sexual innuendo or invitation, abusive language or intimidation, or unseemly behavior or language. And in this age of cyber communications, it is deemed inappropriate and unacceptable to transmit messages or images that contain overtly or subtly personal or sexual content to BGPA's participants.

Particular care must also be taken to protect private information about any participant. This would include health issues, family issues, behavioral issues, addresses, phone numbers, social security numbers, etc. Directors and managers will be provided only with data required for managing their assigned participants. There should be no sharing of such private information between adults. Even group emails should be sent utilizing "bcc," (blind copies), to prevent others from seeing the email addresses of other participants.

In the event that a participant makes inappropriate overtures of any kind toward an adult of BGPA, it is recommended that he or she seeks managerial participation in conducting a private, three-person meeting with that participant in which more appropriate behavioral standards and expectations are defined and mandated. This should be dealt with quickly and directly, but not in a one-on-one meeting. Both adults should write up a synopsis of this incident and provide copies to the President. If the situation is not resolved as a result of this process, then the President and Director/Manager will determine the level of consequence required to protect the adult and organization from any escalation, up to and including expelling the participant from further participation in any BGPA activities.

BGPA has four forms of official communication between participants and adults:

- BGPA emails (theboisegems@gmail.com). This is the favorable way to communicate.

- Mass text and email messages

- Designated Communication Platform (Band App)

- Text messages only if you have a 2 to 1 ratio. This is the least favorable way to communicate.

Social Media

No staff should initiate an opportunity to have participants their personal social media and networking sites (including but not limited to Facebook, LinkedIn, YouTube, Reddit, Tumblr, Snapchat, Instagram, TikTok, Blogs, etc.), or other "buddy-oriented" web addresses. Staff can authorize and accept student-initiated connections to their own personal sites but should not initiate invitations to connect into the participants' personal sites. BGPA adult person is always deemed to be but not limited to an instructor, teacher, etc... not a buddy of the participants.

Boise Gems Performing Arts

Youth Protection Policy

PROHIBITION OF CONSENSUAL RELATIONSHIPS & SEXUAL ACTIVITY

Consensual romantic or sexual relationships and sexual activity of any nature between the staff of BGPA (including faculty as well as staff volunteers) and the students, members, or participants, regardless of their ages is strictly prohibited. This prohibition extends through the full tenure of a participants' involvement in BGPA activities.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I acknowledge receipt of the BGPA Youth Protection Policy. I have read and understand this policy. I will bring any questions, if any, to the attention of the President, Director, and/or Board of Directors.

Date: _____

Print Name: _____

Signature: _____

Boise Gems Performing Arts

Fraternization Policy

Staff/Member Relations

The relationship between Staff/Volunteers and members is central to the mission of Boise Gems Performing Arts (BPGA).

BPGA holds a zero-tolerance policy for consensual sexual relations between Staff/Intern/Volunteers and members. Non-professional ties or fraternization between Staff/Intern/Volunteers and active members is prohibited. Non-professional ties encompass more than only consensual sexual relations. Non-professional ties include dating, romantic relationships, or any ties that go beyond a professional student - teacher/leader type relationship (past or present).

Prohibited interactions include, but are not limited to: inappropriate physical contact, non-professional messaging/texting, 'sexting', inappropriate dialogue, and non-professional or inappropriate sexual messages via any social media or other platform.

Exceptions to the non-professional ties policy exist for immediate family ties such as parent/child, siblings or married couple that have been approved by the activity Director (Corps Director, Ensemble Leader, etc.). Exceptions for short-term volunteers may be granted by the activity Director as long as the Volunteer is not in a position of authority over the member, does not have broad influence, the Rule of Three is followed and safeguards are put in place to ensure appropriate separation between the Volunteer and the member.

For clarity: Sexual or romantic relationships, whether regarded as consensual or otherwise, between individuals in inherently unequal positions is prohibited. Sexual or romantic relationship between a Staff member (instructor or admin) and a member/student - even where consensual and whether or not the member/student is subject to supervision or evaluation by the Staff member - is inconsistent with the proper role of the Staff member and is prohibited. This restriction applies regardless of age of the member/student or the Staff/Volunteer, or whether there are any current or future direct or indirect supervisor responsibilities for that performer.

Rule of Three

No adult Staff or adult Volunteer may be alone with a BPGA member or student at any time. At least two adult Staff/Volunteers must always be present in a vehicle, room, or location with one BPGA member/student OR one adult must always be present with at least two or more participants/members/students. Should a private conversation be needed or a situation need to be addressed privately, two adults need to be present, one of which may simply be an observer within view. In the case of a medical issue/emergency, priority will be given to the transportation of the member to treatment. A member 18 and over may be transported to/from medical treatment with only one adult Staff/Volunteer if they give consent. A member 18 and older may stay at an urgent care, hospital, or the like alone.

Boise Gems Performing Arts Fraternization Policy

Staff/Member Relations Reporting

Staff/Interns/Volunteers must disclose any past or present non-professional ties with members. Members must disclose any non-professional ties with a Staff Member, Intern, or Volunteer. If fraternization is evident, it is your responsibility to report said activity. The procedure for reporting of relationships or incidents is to notify the Director, Board Chair, and fill out the whistleblower form on the website immediately. Appropriate action is taken depending on the details of the incident.

Staff/Staff Relationships

Relationships (romantic or sexual) between adult Staff members or Volunteers are not generally prohibited by these policies. However, if there is a pre-existing non-professional relationship, or one develops where one person is in a position of greater authority or power, they should notify their supervisor to ensure proper oversight is in place where needed.

NOTE: Participants who violate any Gems Drum and Bugle Corps policy, procedure, and/or Federal, State, or Local law may face disciplinary action.

Boise Gems Performing Arts Nondiscrimination Policy

POLICY

Boise Gems Performing Arts does not and shall not discriminate on the basis of race, color, religion (creed), gender, gender expression, age, national origin (ancestry), disability, marital status, sexual orientation, or military status, in any of its activities or operations. These activities include, but are not limited to, the appointment to and termination from its Board of Directors, hiring and firing of staff or contractors, selection of volunteers, selection of vendors, and providing of services.

Boise Gems Performing Arts is an equal opportunity employer. We shall not discriminate and will not discriminate in employment, recruitment, Board membership, advertisements for employment, compensation, termination, upgrading, promotions, and other conditions of employment against any employee or job applicant on the basis of race, color, religion (creed), gender, gender expression, age, national origin (ancestry), disability, marital status, sexual orientation, or military status, or for any other discriminatory reason.

Boise Gems Performing Arts

Whistleblower Policy

Introduction

Boise Gems Performing Arts (BGPA) requires the directors, volunteers, staff, employees, and members of BGPA and its affiliates to act ethically, practice honesty and integrity, and comply with all applicable laws, regulations, ordinances, and BGPA internal policies.

BGPA hopes that all will feel free to raise concerns with BGPA. BGPA recognizes the need to provide a mechanism for the confidential and anonymous submission of such concerns, to provide BGPA full opportunity to investigate and address potential violations of policy, law, or ordinance.

Purpose

Submitting concerns from employees, directors, officers, members, and other stakeholders on a confidential and anonymous basis regarding anything against the policies of the organization, including but not limited to:

- Questionable accounting or auditing matters;
- Questionable business ethics;
- Conflicts of interest;
- Acceptance, provision or solicitation of bribes or kickbacks;
- Legal or regulatory violations;
- Unsafe practices or activities which unnecessarily endanger health or safety;
- Bullying or harassment; and
- Other actions which potentially compromise the integrity of BGPA;

Other primary purposes are the receipt, retention, and treatment of concerns raised and the protection of individuals raising concerns, and their families, from retaliatory actions.

Reporting Responsibility

Every director, volunteer, member, and employee of BGPA and its affiliates has an obligation to report issues as listed in Section II above.

To ensure a confidential forum for reporting concerns, complaints, and issues, BGPA has established a mechanism on its website, and an email address theboisegems@gmail.com, to enable anyone to send an anonymous message.

Investigation

On a case-by-case basis, BGPA shall determine appropriate action. This may include appointing an ad hoc committee of Board members to conduct an investigation, retain outside investigators, counsel, and experts as it deems necessary or appropriate to assist with any investigation or any other acts associated with the issues or concerns raised and report the findings of such investigation back to BGPA, and recommend appropriate corrective action as necessary to the Executive Committee of the Board of Directors.

Boise Gems Performing Arts Whistleblower Policy

Retaliation

BGPA will not retaliate, and prohibits retaliation by its directors, volunteers, members, employees and representatives, against anyone who makes a report in good faith under this BGPA Whistle Blower Policy.

Anyone filing a complaint concerning a violation or suspected violation must be acting in good faith and have reasonable grounds for believing the information disclosed indicates a violation of issues in section II. BGPA reserves the right to take action against anyone who makes a report based upon false or misleading information, or without a reasonable basis for believing any wrongdoing has occurred.

Employee Responsibilities

Nothing in this BGPA Whistle Blower Policy is intended to abrogate any duties BGPA employees owe BGPA, under any applicable laws, regulations or ordinances, to disclose, report violations (or suspected violations) of law or policy, cooperate fully in any investigations, including investigations of harassment, or to fulfill their duty of loyalty to BGPA.

Boise Gems Performing Arts

Background Check Policy

The Boise Gems Performing Arts (BGPA, Gems Drum and Bugle Corps, Inc) organization relies on volunteers and paid staff to support its instructional program. With our need to protect members from potential sexual abuse or other negative influences, BGPA will complete criminal background checks on all volunteers and staff. Therefore, we establish the following policy and process for the screening our volunteer and paid staff.

Each volunteer or staff member who will have regular, direct contact for more than 1 consecutive 24 hour period or who intends to sleep in the same general area as the corps membership shall be subject to a background investigation. An overnight weekend camp or All Days shall be considered as a 24 hour period and subject to background checks.

BGPA shall use an independent entity to process the investigation. As of November 4th, 2025, this company is One Source.

To protect the confidentiality of the volunteer or staff member, the information gathered shall be sent to the BGPA CEO/Executive Director, or reviewed securely online at One Source's admin portal.

The CEO/Executive Director of the program shall have all rights to reject, allow or limit a volunteer or staff member's participation with BGPA based on the information obtained from the background investigation.

A volunteer or staff member who has had their participation rejected by the CEO/Executive Director may appeal the decision to the Board of Directors. In which both parties will be allowed to present their case at the next regularly scheduled meeting of the Board.

BGPA recognizes that at times, the screening process cannot be completed before the volunteer or staff member is needed. In such cases the screening will still occur and volunteer or staff member will be subject to item 4 above.

BGPA will encourage all individuals who might be willing to volunteer or staff for more that the consecutive 24-hour period to complete the background check form in advance of their volunteerism or work.

Individuals who volunteer or work on an annual basis shall be subject to a background investigation every two years, or if otherwise deemed necessary.

BGPA will keep the background information on file for at least two years.

Boise Gems Performing Arts Background Check Policy

ADVERSE ACTION CRITERIA

Subject to extenuating or mitigating circumstances and a majority vote of the BGPA Board of Directors:

A felony conviction of any violent crime, or a misdemeanor conviction for a violent crime within the past 10 years, will disqualify an applicant.

Felony or misdemeanor convictions of any sex-based crime will disqualify an applicant.

Felony conviction of any non-violent crime within the past 10 years, or misdemeanor conviction of a non-violent crime within the past 5 years will generally disqualify an applicant.

Any pending charges for any violent crime or sex-based crime shall be evaluated by the Executive Director on a case-by-case basis.

Any reported convictions that fall outside the scope of the categories identified above shall be evaluated by the Executive Director on a case-by-case basis.